Final Project: Pick a Project

Computer Science - Week 10

Oct 3, 2026 - Version 0.0.2

Please make sure to your UD **email** AND **name** is below. Unless your UD emails are included in this table, then you will not earn any points for this assignment when it is graded! **Every person should submit their own individual worksheet**.

Talk about each of the questions with a friend or our LLM (or both), but **make sure the words you enter below are yours** (with the obvious exceptions notwithstanding). Brainstorming is best done in full sentences, and the main goal here is brainstorming. It's worth reviewing the information in this series of pages in the Drafter documentation to gain a better understanding of the process.

Role	Name	Email
Developer (You)	Josh	jneal@udel.edu
Friend (optional)		

Part 1: The Goal & Prior Implementations

1. **Identify the Goal:** What specific goal are you trying to address? Think about your passions, hobbies, and academic interests. The latter are an excellent candidate to focus on. Some majors have suggestions listed below: these were provided by faculty in those departments. Other majors could consider a focus tied to a big final assignment in one of their recent courses in their major.
    - **Biomedical Engineering** majors may consider one of the following:
        - If you have started (or completed) the Cell/Tissue Design final project in BMEG100, design an organoid, which involves combining a cell type, biomaterial, and testing method. Have the website include a description and diagram of your design concept, a testing method, a needs statement, and an impact statement relevant to their organoid. Also include a link to a paper that supports your idea and a paragraph describing how that paper supports your design concept.

        - Otherwise, create a website related to your BMEG100 Lab Report 1, *Cytoskeletal and Nuclear Staining Lab Report Guidelines*, linked here (University of Delaware account required to access).
    - **Chemistry** and **Chemical Engineering** majors may consider creating an automated chemistry assistant that takes balanced reaction equations, starting reactant masses, and a harvested product amount to determine the limiting reactant, theoretical yield, and percent yield based on principles from Chemistry 2e (OpenStax) — Chapter 4: Chemical Reactions and Stoichiometry. To avoid manually compiling atomic mass tables or writing custom string tokenizers, use the ChemPy library to parse molecular formulas into exact molecular weights and verify reaction stoichiometry against compound data from the NIH PubChem Database. The program outputs an organized breakdown of limiting reagent status, product yields, and remaining masses of unreacted species. Also use the heat of the reaction to determine if it is exothermic or endothermic, and compute the heat flow per mole of the product.
    - Majors in the **Electric & Computer Engineering** department may consider a steganography project that hides messages in images, and then retrieves those messages from uploaded images.
    - **Mechanical Engineering** majors may consider a project that somehow uses both the NumPy and SciPy Python libraries.

My project will help college students find compatible roommates or study partners by comparing lifestyle habits and study preferences, so they avoid conflicts caused by mismatched routines.

2. **Prior Implementations:** Search the internet. What existing tools or websites currently attempt to address it?

An app that currently tries to address it: 1. It's Instagram; you can post yourself to your college Instagram page and find roommates from there. RoomSurf is also a website students use to find roommates or friends. But what they miss is a clear compatibility score, with an explanation of why they match.

3. **Your Implementation:** Briefly describe the legitimate purpose or functionality of your site. How would you want this web application to be used?

It'll be a site where students create a profile with their habits and preferences, then see other profiles ranked by compatibility score, with a short explanation of why they match

together.

Part 2: The Input-Process-Output (IPO) Model

Think about the fundamental flow of your program.

1. **The Core Goal:** Every program has three main phases: taking input, processing data, and presenting output. In one sentence, what is the ultimate goal your program will accomplish for the user? Be specific and use CS1 concepts.

Take a student's habits and preferences, compare them to profiles, and display a ranked list of the best matches.

2. Input: What specific information will the user need to provide to your program? (e.g., a city name, a numerical budget, a list of hobbies).

(TextBox), sleep schedule
(SelectBox) wake up early or sleep in late,
(SelectBox) cleanliness level
(SelectBox) noise level "looking for" roommate or study partner
(CheckBox) smoker or guests-okay
(TextArea) short bio

3. Processing: At a high level, how will the computer manipulate or evaluate that data? (e.g., calculate the average, filter out options that are too expensive, compare the input against a database).

Create a Profile object and add it to the list in State. Loop through the other profiles, use if statements to add points where answers match for example: same sleep schedule, similar cleanliness, and so on, and sort by score.

4. Output: What will the user get back? (e.g., a recommendation, a calculated safety factor, a formatted schedule).

A results page with a ranked list of matches, with each showing a compatibility percentage and the traits y'all share.

Part 3: Data Abstraction

Identify the "nouns" of your problem.

1. **Representing Reality:** Abstraction is the process of representing the real world inside a computer by ignoring unnecessary details. What are the core "things" (nouns) your program needs to track? (e.g., *If building a recipe app, the nouns are "Recipe" and "Ingredient"*).

Profile (a student), Match (a compatibility result between two profiles), and the list of all profiles.

2. **Identifying Properties:** For the most important "thing" you listed above, what 3 to 4 specific details do you actually need to solve your problem, and what details will you abstract away?
    - *Details I need:* (e.g., *Ingredient name, weight, cost*)
    - *Details I will ignore:* (e.g., *Ingredient color, brand, expiration date*)

Profile details I need: name, sleep schedule, cleanliness level, noise level, and whether they want a roommate or study partner.

Ignoring: major, hometown, social media, appearance, exact budget.

Part 4: Challenges, AI Strategy, & Goals

1. **Difficulties:** What parts of this project seem the most difficult or technically complex?

Designing a fair scoring method, keeping state in sync across several pages and routes, and storing data without global variables.

2. **Coding Strategy:** If you will be using an LLM to help code, how will you ensure you understand the generated code and avoid "hallucinations" or "shallow learning" (copying without understanding)? If you won't be using an LLM to help code, this project might take about 4 hours a week to complete, so list each of the days and times in which you work on the project.

I'm thinking of using LLM to see the basics of how to do it and then actually coding it from memory so I can learn.

3. **Goals:** What is your ultimate goal for this project? (e.g., *Impress the graders with a creative UI, build something I can use in my other classes, learn Drafter deeply*).

I just want to build something clean and simple that students can easily use.

Part 5: Research & Brainstorming Conversation

Have a conversation with a Generative AI tool (like ChatGPT or Claude) OR a friend about your project idea. Do not ask for code. Instead, use the AI/friend as a sounding board to research your problem.

1. **The Initial Prompt/Question:** Ask the AI or your friend to help you brainstorm. (e.g., *"I want to build a simple web tool to help students track their study hours. What are 3 common problems students face when tracking their time, and what are 3 simple features a basic tool should have?"*). Paste your prompt below:

I want to build a simple web tool to help match college roommates or study partners based on habits. What are three common problems students have while trying to find a compatible roommate, and what are three simple features the matcher should have>

2. **The Response:** Briefly summarize the best ideas the AI or your friend suggested. What existing solutions or prior apps did they mention?

Common problems student have is mismatch daily routines such as someone going to sleep at 10pm and another stays up until 2. Cleanliness is a big one because some students can be clean freaks, and if their roommate is even somewhat messy, it can cause problems. Lately, little to no information beforehand, sometimes people lie about their answers. *Solutions: A multiple-choice question about sleep, cleanliness, noise level, guests staying, and study style. A ranked match list that gives you the reason you'll be compatible.* *Website found was the university housing survey.*

3. **The Pushback:** You must reply to the AI/friend to narrow the scope when it's over-ambitious. Pick the most complex feature they suggested and explain why it is too complicated for an introductory programming project. Ask them for a simpler alternative. *Paste your response here:*

A weighted algorithm that learn which traits matter most to each user. *Real app/ realtime chat* *UD login*	*Outside my skill set.*

4. **Reflection:** Based on this conversation, how has your project idea changed or become more focused?

I think I became more focused because I like it more.

Part 6: Resource Planning

1. What resources will you use if you get stuck?

I'll go to office hours or ask a TA.

2. If your LLM provides code that causes a Drafter or Bakery error, or if you run into a problem during deployment, what is your step-by-step debugging plan to resolve it?

Get help from a teacher or TA

Part 7: LLM Conversation

If you used an LLM in any part of this work, copy and paste every part of that conversation below. Otherwise, you may be given a zero for the assignment. Obviously, these words will not all be yours, and this is the exception to the requirement at the top of this assignment that all responses be in your own words. If you did not use an LLM to assist you in this assignment, simply say so below.

Designing a fair scoring method, keeping state in sync across several pages and routes, and storing data without global variables.

Part 8: Submit

In Google docs, with this document open, please click on *File* > *Download* > *Microsoft Word (.docx)*, and make sure you put that download somewhere you can find it again. Then, upload it to the Canvas assignment about selecting or brainstorming your final project.

When you're done with this assignment, review this page of the Drafter documentation to better prepare for the next step.